

REFRACTION

A VORATH SKIRMISH MINIATURE GAME • QUICKSTART RULES

CORE RULEBOOK V1.0

The Hook: In the irradiated dead zones where the old signal still sings, the VORATH war-cult undergoes *Refraction*: the crystallization of mortal flesh into living, resonant prism. Higher crystallization brings godlike celestial power—but push too fast, and your warriors shatter into a lethal shower of glass.

1. SETUP & FUNDAMENTALS

Warband Size: 5–10 models per side on a 24" × 24" or 36" × 36" ruined tabletop.

Scale: 28–32mm heroic scale on 25mm–32mm circular/hex bases.

Dice: Standard 6-sided dice (d6). Rolls are *target number or higher* (e.g., 4+ means rolling a 4, 5, or 6 succeeds).

Rounds: Battles last 4–5 Battle Rounds or until one warband breaks.

2. UNIT STAT BLOCK

Every fighter possesses six core attributes printed on their unit card:

- **MOVE (M):** Maximum inches moved per action.
- **MELEE (MEL):** d6 target number to strike in melee (e.g. 4+).
- **RANGED (RNG):** d6 target number for crystal energy.
- **SAVE (SV):** Armor/crystal d6 save against wounds.
- **WOUNDS (W):** Hits sustained before removal.
- **R-GAIN:** Crystallization points banked when triggered.

3. TURN STRUCTURE

Players alternate activating **one model at a time** until all models on the battlefield have acted.

When activated, a model may **Move up to its MOVE** and then perform **ONE Action**:

- **Strike:** Engage in close combat against an enemy model within 1". Roll d6 equal to attacks vs MELEE.
- **Channel:** Fire a crystal laser or beam within 18". Must have line of sight. Roll d6 vs RANGED.
- **Commune:** Deliberately invite the abyss. Automatically gain your unit's **R-GAIN** value immediately.

4. THE REFRACTION (R) TRACK

Models start at **R0**. As spiritual radiation washes over their bodies, they gain **Refraction (R)**, climbing from **R1 to R5**.

How to gain Refraction:

- **Surviving a Wound:** Crystal seals the cracked flesh (+R-GAIN).
- **Commune Action:** Willfully channeling the light (+R-GAIN).
- **Aura of Faith:** Ending an activation within 3" of the Warlord (+1 R).

5. REFRACTION LADDER BOONS

Boons are *cumulative* as the model ascends:

TIER	BATTLEFIELD PHENOMENON
R1	Quickened Pulse: +1" to standard Move speed.
R2	Razor Prism: +1 to hit on all Melee strikes.
R3	Twin Refraction: +1 additional Attack on every Strike.
R4	Living Armor: Automatically ignore the first failed Save each Battle Round.
R5	Prismatic Flare: Channel attacks penetrate in a straight line, hitting all models in a 12" path.

6. PUSH-YOUR-LUCK DECISION

Do you hold at R3–R4 for dependable advantages, or push for R5 and risk triggering the **Fracture Table** on your next surge? Aggressive cults achieve divinity or burst into supernova shards.

THE FRACTURE TABLE

ASCENSION, SHATTERING & BATTLEFIELD SCENARIOS

REFRACTION RULES V1.0

7. OVERLOAD & THE FRACTURE ROLL

The instant any model would advance **beyond R5**, its flesh can no longer contain the celestial radiation. It immediately rolls a single d6 on the **Fracture Table**:

ROLL (D6)	OUTCOME & EFFECT
6	ASCENSION: The warrior transforms! Flip its unit card to the <i>Transfigured Ascension</i> side. Fully heal all wounds; gains permanent flight and unyielding invulnerability.
4 – 5	STABLE BLOOM: The crystal stabilizes in perfect geometric harmony. The model remains permanently at R5 boons, but cannot gain further R for the rest of the battle.
2 – 3	STRUCTURAL FRACTURE: Prismatic stress tears the flesh. The model suffers 1 immediate mortal wound (no save allowed), and its Refraction track resets back to R3.
1	CATAclysmic SHATTER: The model violently detonates into razor-sharp crystal shards. Immediately remove the figure. Every model (friend or foe) within 3" suffers a D3 Melee hit.

8. COMBAT RESOLUTION SUMMARY

- **Hit Roll:** Attacker rolls d6 equal to Attacks. Hits equal or exceed MEL or RNG.
- **Save Roll:** Defender rolls d6 for each hit. Saves equal or exceed SV.
- **Wound Allocation:** For each failed save, reduce Wounds by 1. When Wounds reach 0, remove the casualty.

9. INTRO SCENARIO: "THE RELIQUARY SHRINE"

Objective: A sacred Vorathic Crystal Reliquary stands at the center of the board.

- **Deployment:** Players deploy warbands within 6" of opposite board edges.
- **Objective Scoring:** A player controls the Reliquary if they have more models within 3" than the opponent at the end of a round (worth 2 VP).
- **Shatter Bonus:** Any enemy model destroyed by a Shatter explosion yields +1 bonus VP.
- **Victory:** Player with the most Victory Points after Round 4 claims the shrine.

10. REFERENCE ROSTER EXCERPT

UNIT PROFILE	M	MEL	RNG	SV	W	R-GAIN
The Prism Saint	6"	3+	3+	4+	4	2
Justiciar Duelist	7"	3+	—	4+	2	1
Reveler Fanatic	6"	4+	—	6+	1	1
Laser-Censer Acolyte	5"	5+	4+	5+	1	1
Abyssal Ouroboros	8"	3+	—	3+	6	2

11. CREATOR NOTE

REFRACTION is 100% original intellectual property created for the VORATH universe by Andrew David White Jr. / NorthStar Prime. Designed for 28–32mm miniature play. Compatible with proxy warbands and community skirmish campaigns.